Let's Talk About . . .



Domain:

Oral social interaction

Benchmark:

Engage in short conversations

Description:

Working in pairs, pupils role-play one of the suggested scenarios.

Rationale for choice of topic:

Most children enjoy dramatic activities. Role-playing gives pupils the opportunity to use their imaginations. The suggested scenarios are familiar to children and therefore encourage their active participation.

Suggestions for implementation (prior to and/or during):

Familiarize your class with the concept of role-playing. Brainstorm vocabulary on several topics. Have them practice acting out a variety of scenarios individually or in pairs.

Once the class has been divided into pairs, each pair will choose or be assigned a topic and can practice role-playing. Each pupil may write down some key words on a piece of paper that he or she may refer to during the performance of their conversation. However, they should not write down the entire conversation. The conversation is meant to be as spontaneous as possible.

The role-playing can take place either in front of the class or in front of the teacher while the rest of the class is doing independent work. You may tape pupils' performances to make evaluation easier.

Note: It is very important to teach pupils how to use a checklist before they are given this performance task.

Suggested time allotment:

Approximately three minutes per pair of pupils

Prerequisites:

- Familiarity with role-playing
- Basic verbal skills



Suggested Scenarios

Planning a party
Discuss when and where the party will take place and what you need to do to prepare.

A new pupil in the class
Introduce yourselves and tell something about yourselves and the school.

Do we have homework?
A telephone conversation in which a pupil who was absent from school finds out what homework the teacher gave the class.

My friend broke my glasses
One child accidentally sat on another's glasses. What now?

Please help me look for my lost _____.
Someone is very sad because they can't find their _____. Help them find it.

Let's trade lunches
What's on your sandwich? What else do you have for lunch? Would you like to trade?

May I use your _____?
A request is made to borrow something. What is the answer?

Do you like cats or dogs better?
Some people are cat people and some are dog people. Which are you and why?

Choosing a gift for a classmate who is leaving
Someone is leaving to go to another school. What gift do you think you should give him/her?

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Points	Performance
5	♦ The content of the conversation was appropriate ♦ There was good interaction ♦ Some degree of fluency, with few hesitations ♦ Speech was clear and easy to understand ♦ Only English was used ♦ Skillful use of basic language (word order, verb forms) ♦ Vocabulary was varied
4	
3	♦ The content of the conversation was somewhat appropriate ♦ There was some interaction ♦ Speech was hesitant ♦ Speech was somewhat clear and understandable ♦ English was used most of the time ♦ Adequate use of basic language (word order, verb forms) ♦ Vocabulary was basic
2	
1	♦ The content of the conversation was rarely appropriate ♦ There was little interaction ♦ Found it difficult to speak at all ♦ Speech was unclear and difficult to understand ♦ First language was used often ♦ Limited use of basic language (word order, verb forms) ♦ Vocabulary was limited